

Day 63 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (2): Recent Constitutional Amendment Bills

READING MATERIAL

Covers two major recent Constitutional Amendment Bills — one on removing detained ministers, another on Lok Sabha delimitation and expansion — both still in the legislative process, plus overall Parliament activity statistics for 2025.

Q: What does the Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025 propose, and when was it introduced?

A: Introduced in the Lok Sabha on 20 August 2025. It proposes the REMOVAL of the Prime Minister, Chief Ministers, and other Ministers if they are arrested and remain in detention for 30 CONSECUTIVE DAYS on charges punishable by imprisonment of 5 years or more. It has been referred to a Joint Committee of both Houses for detailed scrutiny (i.e., not yet enacted).

Q: What does the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 propose, and what other bills were introduced alongside it?

A: Introduced on 16 April 2026, alongside the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 and the Delimitation Bill, 2026. Together, they seek to enable Lok Sabha delimitation based on the 2011 Census, increase the maximum Lok Sabha membership to 850 (up to 815 from states, up to 35 from Union Territories), and enable women's reservation in the Lok Sabha to be based on this new delimitation.

Q: As of March 2026, how many times has the Constitution of India been amended in total?

A: 106 amendments since the Constitution was first enacted in 1950.

Q: How many Bills did Parliament pass during the calendar year 2025, and what is one notable example?

A: 39 Bills were passed by both Houses during January–December 2025. A notable example: the Waqf (Amendment) Bill, 2025, aimed at improving management, stakeholder empowerment, and survey/registration/case-disposal efficiency for waqf properties.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025 proposes removal of a Minister if they remain in detention for how many consecutive days?

- A. 15 days
- B. 30 days ✓**
- C. 60 days
- D. 90 days

Explanation: 30 consecutive days. [medium, web-research]

2. Under the 130th Amendment Bill, removal applies to Ministers detained on charges punishable by imprisonment of at least:

- A. 2 years
- B. 5 years ✓**
- C. 7 years
- D. 10 years

Explanation: 5 years. [medium, web-research]

3. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 seeks to enable Lok Sabha delimitation based on which census?

- A. 1991 Census
- B. 2001 Census
- C. 2011 Census ✓**
- D. 2021 Census

Explanation: 2011 Census. [medium, web-research]

4. Under the 131st Amendment Bill, the maximum number of Lok Sabha members would increase to:

- A. 650
- B. 750
- C. 800
- D. 850 ✓**

Explanation: 850. [hard, web-research]

5. As of March 2026, how many times has the Indian Constitution been amended since 1950?

- A. 86
- B. 94
- C. 106 ✓**
- D. 120

Explanation: 106. [hard, web-research]

6. How many Bills did the Indian Parliament pass during the calendar year 2025?

- A. 21
- B. 39 ✓**
- C. 55
- D. 70

Explanation: 39. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Alphanumeric Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Alphanumeric Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, combining letters and numbers in a single pattern. Real exam evidence (independently re-verified) shows three core techniques: letter-to-number position coding, variable-gap letter sequences, and fixed-shift word ciphers.

Q: Method — letter-to-number position coding: If ACEG is coded as 16, and DFGH is coded as 25, how would HIKM be coded?

A: Each letter is converted to its position in the alphabet (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26) and summed. ACEG: A=1, C=3, E=5, G=7, sum=16 ✓. DFGH: D=4, F=6, G=7, H=8, sum=25 ✓. Applying the same rule to HIKM: H=8, I=9, K=11, M=13, sum=8+9+11+13=41.

Q: Method — widening-gap letter sequence: Find the next letter: B, E, I, N, ?

A: Check the gaps between consecutive letters' positions: B(2)→E(5) is +3, E(5)→I(9) is +4, I(9)→N(14) is +5. The gap itself increases by 1 each time, so the next gap is +6: N(14)+6=20, which is T.

Q: Method — fixed-shift word coding (Caesar-cipher style): If ROAD is coded as URDG, how would SWAN be coded using the same rule?

A: Check the shift for each letter: R→U is +3, O→R is +3, A→D is +3, D→G is +3 — a uniform +3 shift applied to every letter. Applying the same +3 shift to SWAN: S→V, W→Z, A→D, N→Q, giving VZDQ.

Q: Method — two-interleaved-sequences letter pair: A pattern alternates first-letters increasing by a fixed gap and second-letters decreasing by the same gap (e.g., AZ, GT, MN, ?, YB). How do you solve it?

A: Track the two positions (first letter, second letter) as SEPARATE sequences. First letters: A(1), G(7), M(13) — increasing by 6 each time, so next is 19=S, then 25=Y (matches the given final term Y). Second letters: Z(26), T(20), N(14) — decreasing by 6 each time, so next is 8=H, then 2=B (matches the given final term B). So the missing term is S+H = 'SH'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If BDFH is coded as 20 (sum of letter positions), what would CEGI be coded as using the same rule?

- A. 22
- B. 24 ✓**
- C. 26
- D. 28

Explanation: C=3, E=5, G=7, I=9, sum=24. (Check rule: B=2, D=4, F=6, H=8, sum=20 ✓ matches given.) [medium, authored]

2. Find the next letter in the sequence: C, F, J, O, ?

- A. S
- B. T
- C. U ✓**
- D. V

Explanation: Gaps: C(3)→F(6) is +3, F(6)→J(10) is +4, J(10)→O(15) is +5, so next gap is +6: O(15)+6=21=U. [medium, authored]

3. If PLAN is coded as SODQ using a fixed letter shift, how would TRIM be coded using the same rule?

- A. WULP ✓**
- B. WUKP
- C. VULP
- D. WULO

Explanation: Shift check: P→S, L→O, A→D, N→Q — a uniform +3 shift. Applying +3 to TRIM: T→W, R→U, I→L, M→P, giving WULP. [hard, authored]

4. In the sequence DY, IT, NO, ?, XE, the first letters increase and second letters decrease by a fixed gap. What is the missing term?

- A. SJ ✓**
- B. SI
- C. TJ
- D. RJ

Explanation: First letters: D(4), I(9), N(14) — gap +5, so next is 19=S, then 24=X (matches given X). Second letters: Y(25), T(20), O(15) — gap -5, so next is 10=J, then 5=E (matches given E). Missing term: SJ. [hard, authored]

Part C – General English: Vocabulary: Singular/Plural (including Zero Plural), Derivatives, and Abbreviations

READING MATERIAL

Covers 'zero plural' nouns (same form in singular and plural, or always one form regardless of number), irregular plurals, and common abbreviations.

Q: Real exam: Is 'Furnitures' a correct plural form? What kind of noun is 'Furniture'?

A: NO — 'Furnitures' is incorrect. Furniture is an UNCOUNTABLE noun with NO plural '-s' form (a 'zero plural' noun) — confirmed by a real exam question, alongside Scissors, Pliers, and News, which are always-plural-FORM nouns that also don't change.

Q: Real exam: Is 'Data' treated as singular or plural in modern usage — "This data is important" or "This data are important"?

A: SINGULAR in standard modern usage: "This data IS important" — even though 'data' is historically the Latin plural of 'datum', it's now conventionally treated as a singular mass noun (similar to 'furniture').

Q: Real exam: Is 'Aircraft' the same in singular and plural? Give the correct usage.

A: Yes — 'Aircraft' is a ZERO PLURAL noun: "The AIRCRAFT ARE ready" (NOT 'aircrafts'), confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: How is 'Fish' pluralised when referring to multiple individual fish?

A: 'Fish' typically stays the SAME in the plural: "Five FISH were in the tank" (not 'fishes', though 'fishes' is occasionally used when referring to multiple different SPECIES of fish) — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: How is 'Sheep' pluralised, and how is 'Goose' pluralised?

A: 'Sheep' stays the SAME in the plural: "one sheep, two sheep" (zero plural). 'Goose' has an IRREGULAR plural: "Geese" (not 'gooses') — both confirmed by real exam questions.

Q: What do the common Latin-derived abbreviations 'e.g.', 'i.e.', and 'etc.' stand for and mean?

A: e.g. (exempli gratia) = 'for example'. i.e. (id est) = 'that is' (used to clarify/restate, not give examples). etc. (et cetera) = 'and so on/and other similar things'.

Q: What do the abbreviations 'RSVP', 'ASAP', and 'FYI' stand for?

A: RSVP (Répondez s'il vous plaît, French) = 'please reply'. ASAP = 'as soon as possible'. FYI = 'for your information'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Which of the following is INCORRECT?

A. Furnitures ✓

B. Scissors

C. Pliers

D. News

Explanation: 'Furnitures' — Furniture has no plural form. [medium, question-bank-2022]

2. Select the sentence with the correct (singular) usage of 'data':

A. These data is important

B. This data are important

C. These datas are important

D. This data is important ✓

Explanation: "This data is important." [medium, web-research]

3. Choose the correct plural usage for 'aircraft':

A. The aircrafts are ready

B. The aircraft are ready ✓

C. The aircrafts is ready

D. The aircraft are readys

Explanation: "The aircraft are ready." [medium, web-research]

4. Identify the correct usage of the zero-plural noun 'fish':

A. Five fish were in the tank ✓

B. Five fishes were in the tank

C. Five fishs were in the tank

D. Five fish was in the tank

Explanation: "Five fish were in the tank." [medium, web-research]

5. Which is the correct usage involving 'scissors'?

A. The scissors is on the table

B. The scissor are on the table

C. The scissors are on the table ✓

D. The scissors was on the table

Explanation: "The scissors are on the table." [medium, web-research]

6. Pick the correctly written plural for 'sheep':

A. One sheep, two sheeps

B. One sheep, two sheep ✓

C. One sheep, two sheepes

D. One sheep, two sheepe

Explanation: "One sheep, two sheep." [easy, web-research]

7. Select the proper plural form of 'goose':

A. Gooses

B. Goosies

C. Geese ✓

D. Geeses

Explanation: Geese. [easy, web-research]

8. What does the abbreviation 'i.e.' stand for?

A. For example

B. That is ✓

C. And so on

D. In other words only in writing

Explanation: "That is" (id est). [medium, web-research]

9. What does 'RSVP' stand for/mean?

A. As soon as possible

B. For your information

C. Please reply ✓

D. For example

Explanation: Please reply. [medium, web-research]